



Beta Monocerotis
1,175 Suns



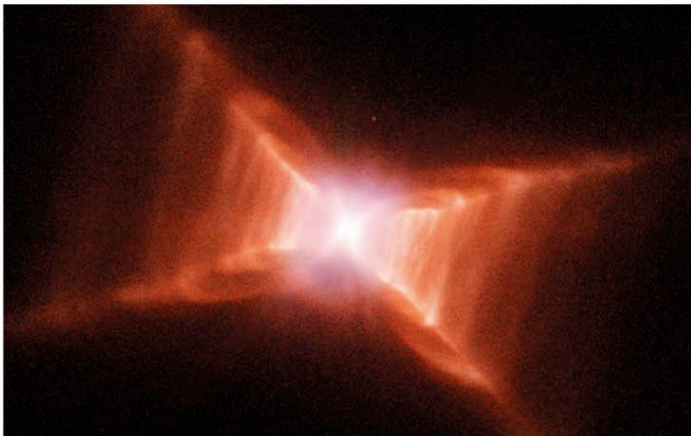
Zeta Monocerotis
1,655 Suns

13 Monocerotis
142,000,000 Suns



△ NGC 2237
The flowery pink gases of NGC 2237 (the Rosette Nebula) surround the star cluster NGC 2244. The stars in the cluster have been born from the nebula and now light up the surrounding gas. The cluster can easily be seen through binoculars, but the faint nebula, larger in apparent diameter than the Full Moon, shows up well only on photographs with large telescopes, as here.

▷ Red Rectangle
The Red Rectangle, seen here through the Hubble Space Telescope, is an unusual planetary nebula in which gas and dust flowing out from the central star has produced a striking X-shaped structure.



KEY DATA

Size ranking 35
Brightest stars Alpha (α) 3.9, Gamma (γ) 4.0
Genitive Monocerotis
Abbreviation Mon
Highest in sky at 10pm January–February
Fully visible 78°N–78°S

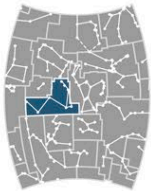


CHART 6

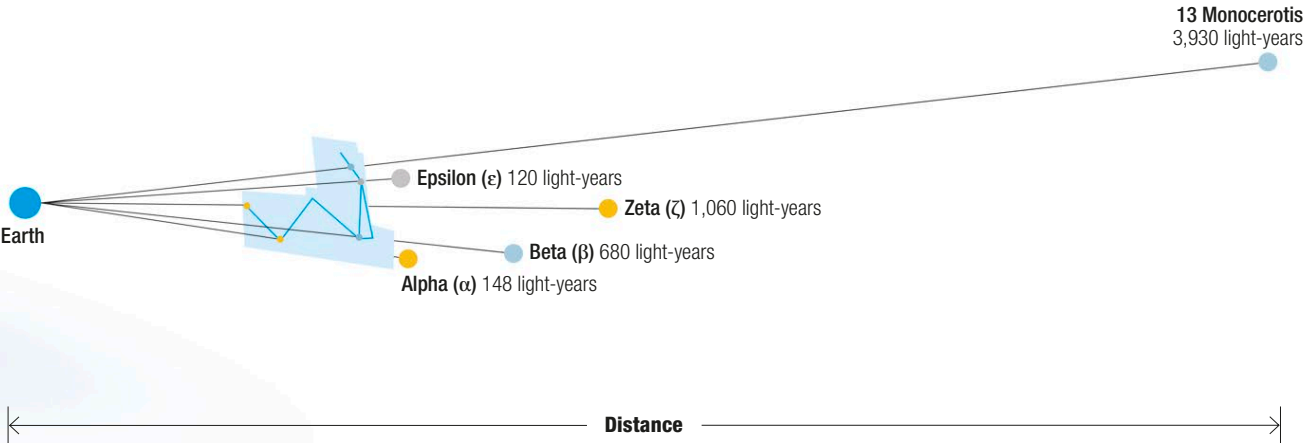
MAIN STARS

Alpha (α) Monocerotis
Yellow giant
☼ 3.9 ↔ 148 light-years
Beta (β) Monocerotis
Triple star; all three are blue-white main sequence stars
☼ 3.7 ↔ 680 light-years
Gamma (γ) Monocerotis
Orange giant
☼ 4.0 ↔ 500 light-years
Delta (δ) Monocerotis
Blue-white main sequence star
☼ 4.2 ↔ 385 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

M50
Open cluster of about 80 stars
Rosette Nebula (NGC 2237)
Nebulosity around cluster NGC 2244
NGC 2264
Open cluster of about 40 stars
Red Rectangle
Planetary nebula about 2,300 light-years away

Monoceros was introduced in 1612 by the Dutch cartographer Petrus Plancius



◁ Star distances
The main pattern stars of Monoceros vary considerably in their distances from Earth. The nearest is Epsilon (ε) Monocerotis (also sometimes called 8 Monocerotis), which is 120 light-years from Earth. The farthest is 13 Monocerotis, which is more than 3,900 light-years away.